

Cuban Pullman Sandwich Loaf

Cuban-bread base → tangzhong for a soft, tight crumb → lidded pain-de-mie bake · one 13×4" loaf

PAN	DOUGH	FLOUR	HYDRATION	BAKE
13×4×4" lidded	~948 g	Sir Lancelot 14.2%	66%	375°F lidded

What changed from the Cuban base: same lard/sugar/salt ratios; hydration up 63% → 66% plus a **tangzhong** (a cooked flour-water paste from within the formula). It locks in water so high-gluten flour bakes **soft and keeps soft**, and the **lid** gives a thin crust + tight square crumb — no steam, no score.

FORMULA

Baker's % on total flour (incl. the tangzhong flour)

INGREDIENT	BAKER %	WEIGHT
Sir Lancelot (14.2% high-gluten)	100%	540 g
Water	66%	356 g
Lard (rendered — tenderness, soft crust)	4%	22 g
Sugar	2%	11 g
Salt	2%	11 g
ADY (bloomed)	1.5%	8 g

Tangzhong (cook first, taken FROM the formula above): 25 g flour + 125 g water. The dough then gets the **remaining 515 g flour and 231 g water** plus everything else. Don't add these as extra — it's a split, not an addition.

METHOD

Same-day ~3.5–4 h at 70°F · grease pan AND lid

- 1 Tangzhong:** whisk **25 g flour + 125 g water** in a small pot. Cook on low, stirring, until it thickens to a paste and the whisk leaves lines (~65°C), ~2–3 min. Scrape out, cool to warm.
- 2 Bloom ADY:** yeast + the sugar in **~90 g of the water at 100–110°F**, 5–10 min to foam. Over ~115°F kills it.
- 3 Mix:** remaining flour (515 g), salt, lard, the cooled tangzhong, the bloom, and the rest of the water. Knead to a **smooth, soft, well-developed dough — near windowpane** (more than the free-form Cuban; a fine even sandwich crumb wants full development). ~8–12 min. Final dough **76–78°F**.
- 4 Bulk:** **~1–1.5 h to doubled** at 70°F — by the dough, not the clock (tangzhong + 1.5% ADY run fast).
- 5 Shape to the pan:** grease pan **and lid**. Degas gently; roll a **tight 13" cylinder**, seam down, to the pan length — **or** divide into **3 equal pieces**, roll each tight, set side-by-side (the evenest crumb). Settle seam-down.
- 6 Proof in the pan** to **~1" below the rim (~80–85% full)** at 70°F, ~45–75 min. **Slide the lid on**. Don't over-proof — lidded + over-proof squashes the crumb or blows the lid.
- 7 Bake 375°F, lidded the whole time, ~35–40 min to 200–205°F internal.** The lid traps steam — flat top, thin soft crust. (Peek near the end; don't unlid early or the top dries.)
- 8 Turn out immediately** onto a rack; optional **butter/lard brush** on top for a softer crust. **Cool COMPLETELY before slicing** — warm sandwich bread gums and tears. Serrated knife.

READ & FIX

Soft, tight, sliceable — cause → correction

Dense, squat crumb	Under-developed or under-proofed. Knead nearer windowpane , and proof to ~1" under the rim before the lid goes on.
Blew the lid / squeezed out the seams	Over-proofed or too much dough. Proof a touch less; hold dough to ~948 g for this pan.
Gummy, tears when sliced	Cut warm, or under-baked. Cool completely and pull at 200–205°F internal.
Crust too thick / tough	Baked too hot/long, or unlidded. Keep the lid on at 375°F , pull at temp — don't bake to color. Once cool, wrap airtight (never fridge it).